Sebastián Quesada Calderón

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Full Stack Engineer | AI Engineering & Security · Goicoechea, San José, Costa Rica · +506 6181 8868 · squesadac@gmail.com · linkedin.com/in/sebas-quesada

Summary

Full Stack Engineer with 5+ years designing and shipping web applications with React, Node.js, TypeScript, and AWS, plus hands-on LLM work on IBM watsonx.ai (a Q&A assistant and a fraud-scoring integration for a fraud-detection platform). CEH-certified and pursuing a Master's in Cybersecurity. Focused on AI engineering and AI security: I build RAG systems, attack them with prompt injection, and measure what works.

Experience

IBM · Software Engineer · Jan 2023 – Present · Costa Rica, Hybrid

- Built a conversational assistant on IBM watsonx.ai for the Gatekeeper fraud-detection platform that answers questions about the project, and connected it through APIs to a supervised model trained on historical fraud / not-fraud cases, so each new case gets a fraud-likelihood percentage based on its characteristics (e.g., number of artifacts).
- Prepared datasets and cleaned and normalized text data for the model.
- Collaborate within a 21-person Agile squad, designing frontend features in React and backend services in Node.js used by a 55-person internal team; participate in code reviews, design discussions, and sprint planning.
- Design, build, and consume RESTful APIs supporting production systems used by enterprise clients.
- Automate testing, validation, and deployment workflows to improve reliability and release speed.
- Deploy and maintain cloud services on IBM Cloud, monitoring performance and resolving production issues; use Bob, IBM's internal AI assistant, for code generation and refactoring.

Tech: React, Node.js, TypeScript, IBM Cloud, PostgreSQL, watsonx.ai

First Factory · Software Engineer · Feb 2022 – Jan 2023

- Built a marketing analytics dashboard from scratch over 3 months, giving leadership and stakeholders visibility into SMS, voice, and email campaign performance.
- Integrated third-party messaging APIs to consolidate multi-channel marketing data into a single reporting view.
- Collaborated with product managers, designers, and engineers in a 10-person cross-functional team; took part in code reviews and production deployments.

Tech: React, Node.js, NestJS, Python, AWS, PostgreSQL

Pancake · Software Engineer · Jan 2020 – Jan 2022

- Built serverless backend services on AWS (Lambda, DynamoDB) for a dual-platform product: a client-facing app and an internal management/design platform.
- Worked in a lean two-person engineering setup alongside the tech lead, owning backend architecture end-to-end.
- Built web applications with React and Next.js, translating business requirements into technical solutions.

Tech: React, Next.js, Node.js, AWS Lambda, DynamoDB

Projects

RAG Security Assistant · github.com/MrDavidson23/rag-security

- Built a local RAG pipeline (ChromaDB, Ollama) over OWASP and NIST security documents; evaluated retrieval on 18 questions checked against the source text (hit@4 94% to 100% after switching to multilingual embeddings).
- Attacked it with indirect prompt injection through a poisoned document: with a naive prompt the injected domain appeared in 4/5 runs, and an output filter blocked 3/10 attempts.
- Built a plan-and-execute agent with citation validation: retries raised valid reports from 3/10 to 7/10 on the same task, while a free tool-calling agent produced 0/10 valid reports (documented in the README).

Skills

- **Web:** JavaScript, TypeScript, React, Next.js, Node.js, NestJS, REST APIs, GraphQL
- **Data and AI:** Python, SQL, Snowflake, ETL, IBM watsonx.ai, RAG (ChromaDB, Ollama), retrieval and agent evals

- **Cloud and infrastructure:** AWS (Lambda, DynamoDB), IBM Cloud, Terraform, CI/CD, Git
- **Security:** LLM security (prompt injection, output filtering), Ethical Hacking foundations, offensive-security coursework (MSc in progress)
- **Databases:** PostgreSQL, MongoDB, DynamoDB, MySQL
- **Practices:** Agile/Scrum, API design, code reviews
- **AI-assisted development:** Bob (IBM internal tool), GitHub Copilot, ChatGPT for code generation, refactoring, and test support

Education

- **Master's in Cybersecurity**, Tecnológico de Costa Rica (TEC) · Jan 2026 – Present
- **Bachelor of Science in Computer Science**, Tecnológico de Costa Rica (TEC) · Jan 2019 – Nov 2022

Certifications

- **Certified Ethical Hacker (CEH)**, Universidad Cenfotec · Sept 2024
- **Scrum Master**, Universidad Cenfotec · Aug 2024

Languages: English (C2)